IGNITE Desktop Simulator

User manual · Community release v0.3.3-desktop.1 · 28 October 2026

IGNITE is a MIDI sequencer with an internal SoundFont synthesizer. This Windows edition combines the released firmware application with an interactive hardware faceplate and desktop audio, MIDI, SoundFont and backup controls. The faceplate is vector artwork and stays sharp when resized; its touchscreen runs the actual firmware UI.

This is an independent community build of Music Tribe's open-source release. It is not an official Behringer manual or a flashable device image. The firmware application reports version 0.3.3; `desktop.1` identifies this community release.



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1. Install and launch

Download the Windows x64 ZIP from the GitHub release. Extract the complete folder, then run **Ignite.exe**. Keep its **assets** directory beside the executable. Launch from the extracted folder rather than opening the executable inside the ZIP.

The package is portable and does not require an installer, Visual Studio or a Python installation to run. Development tools are needed only to rebuild it. A working Windows audio output is required to hear internal sound. Supply your own `.sf2` SoundFont; sample banks are not included.

For a shortcut, right-click the extracted `Ignite.exe` and choose **Show more options → Send to → Desktop (create shortcut)**. Moving the extracted folder later requires updating that shortcut. An existing source-checkout shortcut may instead launch `scripts/run-ignite.ps1`.

Open **DESKTOP SETTINGS** below the faceplate, or press **Ctrl+,**. This is separate from the firmware's own Settings screen in MENU. Desktop Settings contains **Audio**, **MIDI**, **SoundFonts** and **Projects** tabs.

For a larger touchscreen without the surrounding panel, launch `Ignite.exe --touchscreen` from PowerShell or add `--touchscreen` to a shortcut's target arguments. Ctrl+, still opens Desktop Settings.

2. The panel and keyboard

Most panel buttons depend on the current screen and selected object. Start with the mode buttons, then select the song, scene, track or pattern you want to edit.

Control	Mouse operation
Touchscreen	Click a control; drag where the firmware supports dragging.
Buttons and 16 pads	Press and release. Hold the mouse button to send the firmware's hold action.
16 step encoders	Drag vertically or scroll to turn; click without dragging to push.
Knobs A–H	Drag vertically or scroll to turn.
ROW and BAR	Drag or scroll to change the current row/bar as defined by the active screen; click to push.
Jog / Enter	Drag vertically or scroll to navigate; click to select.
SHIFT	Click to toggle the firmware Shift state; click again to release it.
Return, Copy, − and +	Send the corresponding firmware navigation/edit action.

Keyboard	Action
F1	MENU
F2	SONG
F3	SCENE
F4	TRACK
F5	PATTERN
Space	PLAY
Esc	STOP
Ctrl+S	SAVE
Ctrl+,	Desktop Settings

Hover over a panel control for its tooltip. When typing in a text field, the panel avoids intercepting its normal typing keys. If a mode shortcut seems inactive, leave the text field and click the panel first.

This simulator does not turn the PC keyboard into a MIDI piano. Use a MIDI input for performed notes, or enter events in the pattern editors. The panel pads have screen-specific sequencer functions; do not assume KICK drum-pad behavior.

3. Songs, scenes, tracks and patterns

Object	Role
Song	Holds scenes and song-level sequencing settings.
Scene	Holds an arrangement of tracks and scene-level timing/performance settings.
Track	Connects patterns to instruments; also holds track transforms, mute and recording state.
Pattern	Contains bars, steps, note events and auxiliary events. Patterns have their own library.
Instrument	Describes a MIDI port/channel and/or an internal sound selection. Instruments have their own library.
Receive instrument	Specifies the input port and channel a track listens to.
Output instrument	Specifies where the track sends events and which internal preset it uses.

Creating a song does not create a ready-to-play scene, pattern and sound assignment. An empty pattern or an unassigned output instrument can be perfectly valid and silent.

The source supports up to **64 tracks**, **16 step positions per bar**, **16 bars per pattern**, scene lengths up to **200 bars**, **96 PPQN** timing and a registered tempo range of **20–360 BPM**. These are software limits, not a claim that 64 heavily layered instruments can play without dropouts.

Patterns and instruments can be reused. Editing a reused library object may affect more than one assignment. Copy it before making a variation that should remain independent. Save after the change.

4. Make your first sequence

This walkthrough uses internal audio and does not require a MIDI controller. The underlying create/edit/save/play workflow is covered by model tests; the test harness does not click every control in these screens.

1. **Load a bank.** Open Desktop Settings → SoundFonts → **Load SoundFont…** and select an SF2. A complete GM bank makes the original firmware preset names useful; a single-instrument bank also works with the desktop browser.
2. **Create a song.** Press SONG / F2. Use the empty-list creation control or **+ Add New Song**, then select the new song.
3. **Create a scene.** Press SCENE / F3. Use the scene creation control or **+ Add New Scene**, then select it. Tracks belong to this scene.
4. **Create an instrument.** Open MENU / F1 → Instrument and use its creation control. Note the instrument's name.
5. **Choose its sound.** Return to Desktop Settings → SoundFonts. Select a preset, select that instrument in the lower selector, and press **Assign to instrument**. This enables internal sound and saves the instrument selection.
6. **Create a pattern.** Open PATTERN / F5 and use its creation control or **+ Add New Pattern**. Choose a polyphonic pattern if you want chords; a monophonic pattern is sufficient for a simple melody.
7. **Connect the track.** Open TRACK / F4, select a track, and assign your pattern and output instrument. Ensure the track is not muted. A receive instrument is needed for MIDI recording, but not for entering notes with the mouse.
8. **Enter a few notes.** Open the assigned pattern. Use its step/event editor or grid tools to add notes, with nonzero velocity and duration, and enable the relevant steps. For a short test, use a one-bar sixteenth-note pattern and put notes on positions 1, 5, 9 and 13.
9. **Play.** Press PLAY or Space. If silent, check the track assignments, mute state and audio output before changing more settings.
10. **Save and reopen.** Press SAVE / Ctrl+S, stop playback and close Ignite. Launch again and select the song and scene to confirm your arrangement is there.

Use the larger touchscreen mode if small firmware fields are difficult to read. Loading a SoundFont stops playback; after changing banks, choose presets that actually exist in the new bank.

5. Patterns and note editing

The firmware includes pattern list, bar, step/event and grid views. These are views of the same pattern data. Use the screen's current selection and parameter labels to determine what the pads, encoders, ROW and BAR controls will change.

A note event includes pitch, velocity, length in steps/ticks and a tick offset. Multiple notes can occupy a step in a polyphonic pattern. Velocity zero, a disabled step, a muted track or an unavailable preset can each explain a silent note.

Parameter	Musical effect
Pitch / note	Selects the note played by the output instrument.
Velocity	Controls note strength; how strongly it changes the tone depends on the preset.
Length in steps	Sets the coarse duration.
Length in ticks	Adds finer duration control.
Offset	Moves the event relative to the step boundary.
Time base	Changes the rhythmic spacing of the pattern's step positions.

Bar operations include copying, appending, duplicating, inserting and removing. The desktop regression suite covers independent copies, correct note/step positions, the 16-bar cap and retaining at least one bar. Save a backup before a large rearrangement.

Auxiliary events, triplet time bases and the broader editing tools exist in the source. Coverage varies by operation; see the feature-status table rather than assuming every combination was exercised.

6. Playback and performance

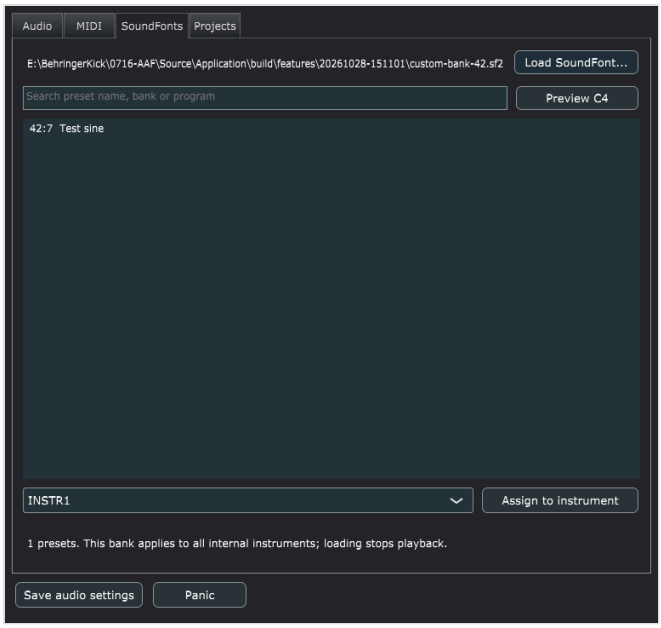
PLAY starts or resumes the current arrangement; STOP ends the current transport action. The firmware decides the precise behavior from its current transport state. Pause/resume, tempo changes and normal stop commands are covered by desktop workflow tests.

The front panel also exposes NEXT/TIE, FILL/X, SOLO/SKIP, GANG and SCULPT. These depend on the active view and track/pattern configuration. The source contains main/fill patterns, grouped operations, scale/transpose transforms and sculpt changes to notes and velocities. Their presence is documented from code; this release does not certify every performance combination.

Start with the internal clock. Source settings also cover MIDI clock, MIDI Machine Control, remote control and sync connections. Timing accuracy against external equipment has not been measured. Selecting an external clock source without providing that clock can leave playback waiting.

Knobs A–H have the front-panel labels **Release, Cutoff, Resonance, Volume, Reverb, Chorus, EQ High and EQ Low**. Their actual response depends on the active firmware context and instrument/effect setup. Effects and transforms can change loudness; use moderate output levels while exploring.

7. SoundFonts and internal instruments



Use **Load SoundFont...** to choose an existing SF2. The Windows build can load it directly from your sample collection, including Unicode paths. Loading replaces the **one shared bank used by every internal instrument** and stops playback. It does not give each track a separate SF2 file.

The preset list shows **bank:program** followed by the preset name. Both numbers start at zero. Search by name or number. This lists the actual presets in the loaded file, so banks with custom numbering are usable without remapping their samples.

Select a row and press **Preview C4**, or double-click the row, to hear a short note while stopped. Preview does not require a track assignment. A drum preset may have no sample on that particular note; silence on C4 alone does not establish that the bank is invalid.

To use the preset in a sequence, choose an existing instrument below the list and press **Assign to instrument**. The assignment is saved with the instrument. Assign that instrument to the track's output. The original firmware GM picker remains available for conventional bank-0 programs and its mapped bank-128 drum sets.

The chosen bank path is remembered in the Windows preferences. Custom bank/program assignments survive saved arrangements and backups, but the SF2 itself remains external. Moving or deleting that file can silence internal playback. A replacement bank with different presets may require new assignments.

Engine property	Current behavior
Bank format	SF2. SF3 support is not established.
Shared bank	One loaded file, with independent per-track synth state.
Voices	Eight allocated per track; layered presets may consume several voices per note.

Engine property	Current behavior
Synthesis	Mono, 48 kHz. Output is resampled to the Windows device rate.
Missing preset	Silent instead of reusing a previous valid preset.
Failed replacement load	Retains the previously loaded bank.

No commercial SoundFonts are bundled. Use files whose license permits your intended use. This release also does not expose the entire separate AudIO/Airwindows effect collection through the firmware UI.

8. Windows audio

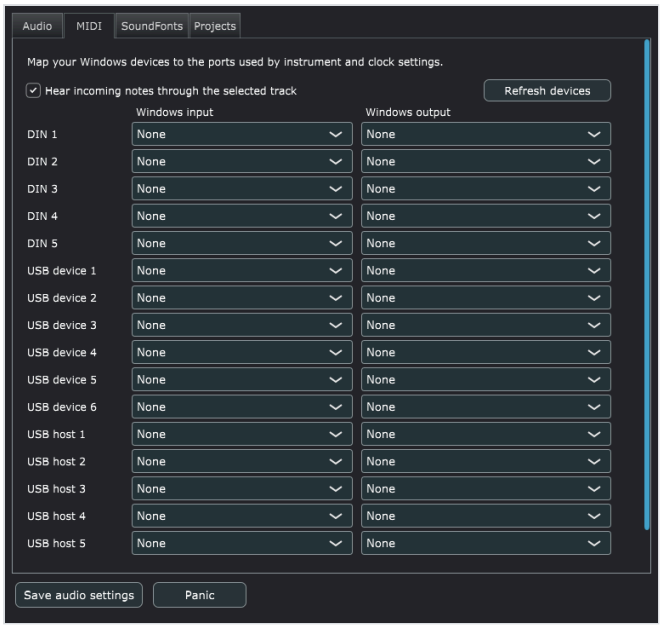
Open Desktop Settings → **Audio**, choose the output device, sample rate and buffer size, then press **Save audio settings**. Windows may negotiate 44.1 kHz even when the engine requests 48 kHz; the desktop output adapter converts between the engine and device rates.

Play, input monitoring and preset preview can open the audio device. Stop, pause or the end of a preview can close it, so seeing a closed device while idle is expected. If an output becomes unavailable, reconnect it and retry playback. The public build has ASIO disabled.

Panic clears sounding internal notes. It is useful after interrupted input or when testing a preset with a long release. It does not promise to reset every external MIDI instrument.

The audio path uses a 960-sample internal render block, then adapts to the driver's callback size. Smaller Windows buffers do not remove all engine or device latency. Editing or saving can briefly interrupt audio because the desktop protects model changes with a shared lock. Bluetooth devices can add substantial delay.

9. MIDI connections and routing



The MIDI tab maps Windows MIDI device names to the firmware's **five DIN, six USB-device and five USB-host logical ports**. These are software routes: mapping a controller to DIN 1 does not create a physical DIN jack on the PC.

1. Connect your controller or install an appropriate virtual MIDI port outside Ignite.
2. Open Desktop Settings → MIDI and press **Refresh devices**.
3. Choose its Windows input on a logical port row, such as USB device 1.
4. Set the track's receive instrument to that same logical port and MIDI channel in the firmware UI.
5. Assign an output instrument with internal sound enabled if you want Ignite to make the sound.
6. Leave **Hear incoming notes through the selected track** enabled for monitoring.

Input and output choices are independent. Outputs initially use **None**, preventing unexpected duplication through the Windows software synth. To drive an external device, select its Windows MIDI output on the logical row used by the track's output instrument.

The interface uses channels 1–16; internal data stores them as 0–15. A channel mismatch can prevent both monitoring and recording. Multiple logical rows can use the same device, which may duplicate messages; map only the rows you need.

Routes and the monitoring option save automatically. If startup reports a missing device, reconnect it, refresh and select the route again. Avoid routing an output back to its own input unless you deliberately want that loop and have configured filtering.

No MIDI input devices were connected for release testing. Internal messages exercised the same router entry point and all 16 logical port IDs; physical controllers, driver behavior, external output and external-clock timing remain unverified.

10. Step and live recording

Both methods need a selected song, scene and track, an assigned pattern, a matching receive instrument and enabled note recording in the firmware record settings. Enable internal monitoring if you want to hear the performed notes.

Step entry while stopped

1. Stop playback and select the pattern/track you want to record.
2. Set the input port/channel and note-event recording filter.
3. Press REC to enter step recording.
4. Play and release notes on the matching input. Notes on other channels should be ignored.
5. Stop recording, then inspect the pattern's events and save.

The internal test records two accepted notes, rejects another channel, saves and reopens them in a fresh process. Step recording is MIDI note entry; it is not an audio recorder.

Live recording during playback

1. Assign the track's receive instrument and pattern, then enable the track's recording state.
2. Start playback and press REC to enter live recording.
3. Play the notes, including note releases.
4. Stop recording before closing or changing the arrangement, then save.
5. Inspect note velocity and duration in the pattern editor.

The test checks an armed track, captured velocity/duration, stopping immediately after note-off and reopening the saved result. Unarmed tracks should not record. This verifies the internal event path, not the latency or timing of a physical controller.

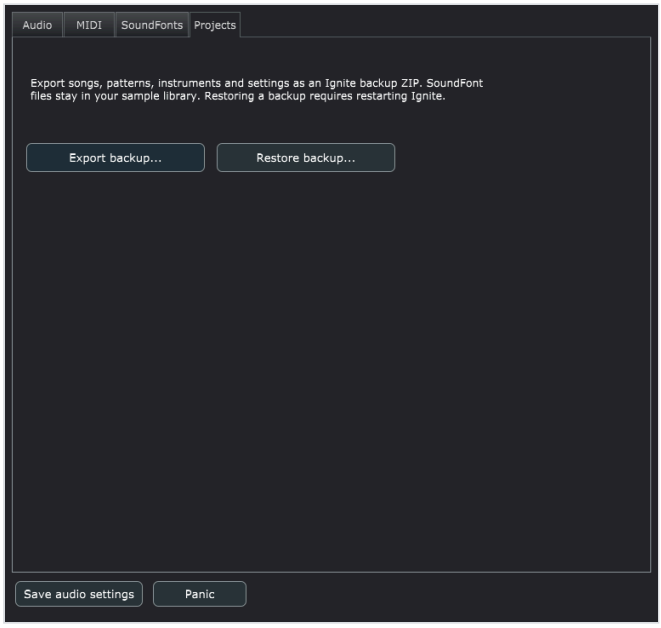
11. Save, export and restore

Press **SAVE / Ctrl+S** before closing. The desktop build does not add an automatic save prompt. Save All includes the latest pattern edits and scene-only changes in the repaired desktop paths.

Windows data is stored separately from the extracted application:

Location	Contents
`%APPDATA%\BehringerIgnite\Ignite_folder`	Songs, patterns, instruments and firmware settings.
`%APPDATA%\BehringerIgnite\desktop.json`	Windows audio settings, MIDI routes, monitoring preference and SoundFont path.
Your chosen SF2 location	The sample bank; it remains outside project storage.

Upgrading the extracted app does not require copying the data into its folder. Export a backup before upgrading. Run only one Ignite process against a given data directory.



Export backup… saves the libraries and writes an Ignite ZIP containing songs, patterns, instruments, firmware settings and the library index. **Restore backup…** validates and stages a compatible backup before replacing the saved collection. After a successful restore, close Ignite using the completion message, then launch it again.

Restoring replaces the collection rather than merging it. Export the current collection first if you need to retain it. The archive does **not** contain SF2 sample files or Windows device preferences, so keep the bank available and review audio/MIDI selections on another PC.

Song, scene, pattern and desktop restore replacements retain recovery directories. A missing library from an interrupted directory swap is recovered at startup. Recovery copies are not a substitute for an exported backup, and Save All is not one transaction across all possible settings files.

12. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Checks
App opens with missing artwork	Extract the whole ZIP and keep `assets` beside `Ignite.exe`.
Preview works, sequence is silent	Select a song and scene; check the track's pattern, output instrument, mute state, enabled steps and note velocity.
Nothing makes sound	Load a valid SF2, select an existing preset, check the Windows output and retry Play or Preview.
A custom bank is silent with GM names	Use the desktop SoundFont browser's actual bank/program list and assign that preset to the instrument.
Preview is silent only on a drum preset	C4 may be unmapped; test appropriate drum notes in a pattern.
No MIDI devices appear	Connect the device, close other apps that may own it, then Refresh. Ignite does not create virtual drivers.
MIDI arrives but is not heard/recorded	Match the logical port and channel, assign a receive instrument, enable monitoring/note filters, and arm the track for live recording.
Playback waits or does not advance	Check the selected clock source; use internal clock for the first test.
Audio crackles or feels delayed	Try a wired output and another buffer size; reduce active voices/effects and avoid large edits during playback.
Old notes keep sounding	Use Desktop Settings → Panic and check note-off input/routing.
A restored project looks unchanged	Close and reopen Ignite; restore replaces saved files, then startup reloads the libraries.
Desktop shortcut stops working	Confirm the extracted/source folder has not moved and update the shortcut target.
Debug takes a long time to exit	Use Release for normal operation; inherited UI allocations produce a long Debug CRT leak report.

For a file log, set `IGNITE_LOG` to a writable path before launch. Source-checkout launches through `scripts/run-ignite.ps1` log to `Source/Application/build/win/ignite.log`. Logs can include local paths, so review them before posting publicly.

13. Feature status and limits

Status	Release coverage
Tested on Windows	Build and startup, vector panel navigation, model creation/editing/copying, save/reopen, staged-save recovery, track counts through 64, playback edits, device audio and rate conversion.
Tested with internal MIDI	Logical input/output routing, channel-filtered step recording, live velocity/duration, saved recordings and fresh-process verification.
Tested desktop services	Actual SF2 preset enumeration, non-GM assignment and preview, failed-bank retention, preferences and backup/restore round trips, unsafe/corrupt archive rejection.
Present in source; coverage varies	All editor combinations, auxiliary events, main/fill performance, gang/sculpt, scales/transpose, remote control and external clock options.
Requires physical testing	MIDI controllers and external destinations, DIN/USB hardware endpoints, CV/Gate voltages, sync jacks, calibration, updates and hotplug behavior.
Incomplete device distribution	MCU firmware, Wi-Fi firmware and the proprietary PC transfer service were omitted upstream. A complete flashable image is not supplied.
Known desktop limitation	Debug retains UI allocations and reports them slowly at exit. The shared model lock can cause brief audio gaps during edits/saves.

The synth is mono and voice-limited. This simulator is not an emulation of the MCU, electrical I/O or device storage hardware. The optional VST source is a template, not an Ignite plugin supplied by this release.

14. Developer and release reference

Source: chillbeast/0716-AAF, branch **desktop-build**. Upstream: MusicTribeOpenSource/0716-AAF, base commit `0371a3ea22fc530e23e2321068a0b8835e1e6502`.

To build the simulator, supporting libraries and helpers, run from the repository root:

```
.\scripts\build-windows.ps1 -DebugBuild -Package
```

See Windows build instructions for Visual Studio, CMake, JUCE and Python requirements. Reproduce the expanded desktop feature checks with:

```
.\scripts\features-windows.ps1 -Configuration Release
.\scripts\workflow-windows.ps1 -Configuration Release -NodeEdit -AudioDevice -
SimulateInterruptedSave
```

Tests use disposable directories under the ignored build tree. The release was checked with **54 native Release/ASan checks**, **55 native Debug checks**, **107 arrangement workflow checks**, **75 desktop feature/setup/reopen checks**, **91 no-font workflow checks under ASan**, **seven smoke checks per font/no-font case**, and **five packet-protocol checks**. These counts describe overlapping suites, not a count of every supported feature. Final sanitizer runs reported no address errors.

The separate AudIO, DAW and Airwindows libraries also build, but the main app uses its firmware TinySoundFont path. Detailed evidence and remaining audit items are in AUDIT_FIXES.md, CAPABILITIES.md and DEVELOPMENT.md.

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